

that he could write poetry. Atul loved playing the guitar. I think secretly he wanted to be a rock musician," says Niyam.

People who knew Chitnis felt that he was not an easy man to deal with. Niyam remembers, "Atul was a controversial man. He was arrogant but the best part of his personality was that he was never repentant about his behaviour. He actually used his arrogant behaviour to his advantage, knowing that he could get his job done this way. There are many people that I know who have been rubbed the wrong way by him, both in the community and the corporate world, yet his persona was so crazy that nobody dared to say anything to him."

But people who have a balanced view on Chitnis opine that while on the one hand, he brought the international community to India for FOSS and promoted open source technology amongst all, including academia and the corporate world, he also offended a lot of very significant and influential people who could have brought about an even higher adoption of FOSS in India.

Yet there's hardly anyone who denies his passion for technology and his love for FOSS. His attitude towards life and his love for FOSS made Atul Chitnis the man he was. RIP Atul Chitnis. We, the lovers of open source technology, will always miss you.

Niyam Bhushan wishes his friend good-bye

Restless In Peace

Atul Chitnis is not dead. Not yet. And he couldn't be in heaven. Not with that arrogant attitude, beer breath, and electric guitar slung across his back. That Atul needs to go to hell is obvious to every living person. Because hell is wherever proprietary software is used. It's the ultimate tool of the devil to torture and torment clueless souls with viruses, Blue Screens of Death, crashes, and the usurping of every notion of freedom known to God and man. Hell is where the helpless are forever chained to an endless cycle of costly upgrades as they hopelessly plead for an escape from vile bugs.

Atul needs to catch the devil by the tail -f command. He needs to burn an even more raging fire in hell. How Ol' Nick will tremble when Atul thunders: "Show Me The Core Of Hell." Kicking and screaming, Atul is going to liberate and deliver those spiritless souls to the eternal bliss and freedom of FOSS.

And that, ladies and gentlemen, is how Toolz will debug and compile his own Heaven.



Twitterati Speak



Mahesh Murthy
@maheshmurthy

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RIP #AtulChitnis Knew you from 90s, then as Geodesic's CTO, then mentor to tech souls. Will miss you & your spirit, man.

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Rest in peace @AtulChitnis - it was a pleasure listening to you speak at our Hack Day and serving you as a customer.
pic.twitter.com/9yhMqWNLDE

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Mahendra Paisule
@ScepticClerk

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RIP @AtulChitnis This is very sad news. A great loss for the Indian techie community.

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One always thinks one has time. To spend with friends. And then all you have is regret, for not having found time. I'll miss you @AtulChitnis

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Santosh K P
@kps_santosh

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My first memories of @AtulChitnis was seeing him on stage for the opening ceremony of @fossum09. Felt like opening of door of brilliance

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